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ETHICAL PRICING STRATEGIES AND CONSUMER FAIRNESS PERCEPTION IN ONLINE MARKETS

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ABSTRACT:

In recent years, online markets have expanded rapidly due to the growing use of digital platforms and e-commerce technologies. One important issue that has emerged in this context is the use of dynamic and algorithm-based pricing strategies. While these strategies help companies maximize profit and manage demand efficiently, they also raise serious ethical concerns regarding fairness and transparency. Many consumers feel that prices in online markets are inconsistent and sometimes unfair, which negatively affects their trust and purchase behavior.

This study examines how ethical pricing strategies shape consumers' perceptions of fairness in online markets. Ethical pricing refers to pricing practices that are transparent, non-discriminatory, and justifiable to consumers. The research proposes that transparency and honesty in pricing play a critical role in shaping consumer trust, which further affects their perception of fairness. A conceptual framework is developed to analyze the relationship between ethical pricing, transparency, trust, and consumer behavior.

The findings suggest that when consumers clearly understand the reasons behind price changes, they are more likely to perceive the pricing as fair. On the other hand, hidden or unclear pricing mechanisms reduce trust and lead to negative reactions such as dissatisfaction and reduced purchase intention. This study contributes to the existing literature by integrating ethical considerations into pricing strategies and highlighting the importance of consumer-centric approaches in digital markets.

Keywords: Ethical Pricing, Consumer Fairness, Online Markets, Dynamic Pricing, Transparency

1. Introduction

In the modern digital era, online markets have grown very fast due to the increasing use of the internet and smartphones. E-commerce platforms such as Amazon, Flipkart, and other digital marketplaces allow consumers to buy products anytime and from anywhere. This rapid growth has also introduced new pricing strategies, especially dynamic pricing, where prices change based on demand, time, user behavior, and competition.

Dynamic pricing is widely used because it helps companies increase profit and manage inventory efficiently. For example, prices may increase during high demand or decrease during sales. However, this type of pricing raises major concerns among consumers. Many users feel that the same product is sold at different prices to different people, which creates a sense of unfairness. This problem directly affects consumer trust and satisfaction.

From an ethical point of view, pricing should be transparent, fair, and justifiable. Ethical pricing means that companies should not misuse customer data or manipulate prices in ways that harm consumers. When pricing is unclear or seems biased, consumers may feel cheated, reducing their trust in the platform. Studies have shown that fairness perception plays a very important role in consumer decision-making in online environments [1].

Another important issue is the use of algorithms and artificial intelligence in pricing. These systems automatically adjust prices based on user data such as browsing history, location, and purchasing behavior. While this improves efficiency, it also raises ethical concerns regarding privacy and discrimination. Consumers are often unaware of how these prices are decided, which increases confusion and dissatisfaction.

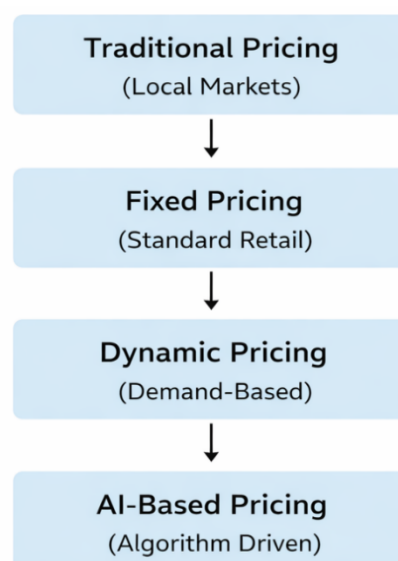


Figure 1: Evolution of Pricing Strategies in Markets

Fairness perception is not only about price value but also about the process behind pricing. If consumers believe that the pricing process is honest and transparent, they are more likely to accept price changes. On the other hand, hidden pricing strategies or sudden price changes can lead to negative emotions such as anger and distrust.

Table 1: Comparison of Traditional Pricing vs Online Dynamic Pricing

Factor	Traditional Pricing	Online Dynamic Pricing
Price Stability	Fixed	Frequently changing
Transparency	High	Low
Consumer Trust	High	Medium/Low
Data Usage	Minimal	High
Fairness Perception	High	Often questioned

Therefore, it is important to study how ethical pricing strategies can improve consumers' perceptions of fairness. This research analyzes the relationship among pricing transparency, ethical practices, and consumer trust in online markets.

The main objectives of this study are:

- To understand the concept of ethical pricing in online markets
- To analyze how pricing transparency affects consumer fairness perception
- To examine the role of trust in consumer decision-making
- To propose a model for fair and ethical pricing strategies

This study is important because it provides useful insights for businesses to design better pricing strategies that are not only profitable but also fair and acceptable to consumers. It also helps in building long-term relationships between companies and customers in digital environments.

2. Literature Review with Research Gap

2.1 Ethical Pricing in Online Markets

In online markets, ethical pricing refers to setting prices in a fair, transparent, and non-exploitative manner. With the rise of digital platforms, companies now use customer data such as browsing behavior, location, and purchase history to adjust prices. While this improves efficiency, it also creates ethical concerns. Consumers often feel uncomfortable when they realize that different users may see different prices for the same product.

Recent studies show that when pricing decisions are not transparent, consumers perceive them as unethical. Lack of clarity, hidden rules, and possible discrimination are the major reasons behind this perception [2]. Therefore, ethical pricing is not only about price value but also about how the price is decided and communicated.

2.2 Dynamic Pricing and Fairness Perception

Dynamic pricing is a strategy where prices change based on demand, time, and market conditions. It is widely used in industries like airlines, hotels, and e-commerce. Although it helps businesses increase revenue, it often creates fairness concerns among consumers.

Research shows that when consumers notice price differences without a clear justification, they perceive the pricing as unfair. For example, if two customers buy the same product at different prices, it reduces satisfaction and trust [3]. Fairness perception becomes even weaker when price changes are frequent and unpredictable.

2.3 Personalized Pricing and Privacy Issues

Personalized pricing is a more advanced form of dynamic pricing where prices are adjusted for individual users. This is done using personal data such as search history, device type, or location.

Studies indicate that consumers react more negatively to personalized pricing compared to general pricing strategies. When users feel that their personal data is being used to manipulate prices, it raises privacy concerns and reduces perceived fairness [4]. This shows that ethical concerns are strongly linked with data usage in online pricing.

2.4 Algorithmic Pricing and Consumer Trust

Modern online platforms use algorithms and artificial intelligence to set prices automatically. These systems analyze large amounts of data and adjust prices in real time.

However, research shows that algorithmic pricing reduces consumer trust when the process is not understandable. Consumers prefer stable and predictable pricing. When prices change frequently without

explanation, it creates confusion and dissatisfaction [5]. Therefore, trust becomes a key factor in the perception of fairness.

2.5 Role of Transparency in Pricing

Transparency plays a very important role in improving perceptions of fairness. When companies clearly explain why prices change, consumers are more likely to accept those changes.

Studies suggest that transparency reduces negative reactions and increases trust. For example, showing reasons such as increased demand, limited stock, or seasonal variation helps consumers understand pricing decisions [6]. Thus, transparency acts as a bridge between pricing strategy and consumer fairness.

To better understand the relationship between ethical pricing and consumer behavior, a conceptual model is presented below.

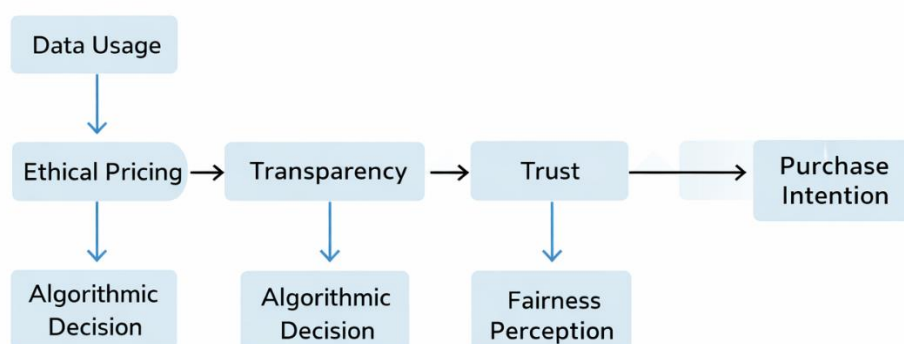


Figure 2: Consumer Fairness Perception Model

Figure 2: Consumer Fairness Perception Model showing the relationship between ethical pricing, transparency, trust, and purchase intention, along with influencing factors.

This model explains how ethical pricing improves transparency, which builds consumer trust. Increased trust leads to higher fairness perception and ultimately influences purchase intention. External factors such as data usage, algorithmic decisions, and price discrimination also impact this process.

Table 2: Summary of Key Studies (2018–2024)

Ref No.	Author & Year	Focus Area	Key Finding
[2]	Paraschiv et al. (2025)	Ethical pricing	Lack of transparency leads to an unethical perception

[3]	Alderighi et al. (2022)	Dynamic pricing	Price differences reduce fairness perception
[4]	Priester et al. (2020)	Personalized pricing	Individual pricing is seen as unfair
[5]	Vomberg et al. (2024)	Algorithmic pricing	Reduces trust if not understood
[6]	MDPI Study (2024)	Pricing transparency	Transparency improves fairness and trust

This table summarizes recent research studies (2018–2024) on pricing strategies in online markets. The findings clearly indicate that transparency and ethical pricing play a key role in improving consumers' perceptions of fairness, whereas personalized and algorithmic pricing often reduces trust when not properly explained.

Research Gap:

Although many studies have analyzed pricing strategies in online markets, important gaps remain.

First, most studies focus on dynamic pricing from a business perspective, but they do not consider ethical aspects such as fairness and transparency in depth. Second, research on personalized and algorithmic pricing primarily addresses privacy issues but does not fully explain how these factors influence overall consumer trust and perceptions of fairness.

Third, there is a lack of a simple, integrated model that connects ethical pricing, transparency, trust, and perceptions of fairness within a single framework. Most existing studies analyze these factors separately, creating a gap in understanding the overall relationship.

Therefore, this study aims to fill this gap by proposing a model that clearly explains how ethical pricing strategies influence consumers' perceptions of fairness through transparency and trust in online markets.

3. Research Design

This study employs a conceptual research design to examine how ethical pricing strategies influence consumers' perceptions of fairness in online markets. The model is developed based on existing literature, which highlights the importance of transparency, trust, and fairness in digital pricing environments. Ethical pricing is considered a key starting point, as it ensures that pricing practices are fair, transparent, and

justifiable to consumers. When companies follow ethical pricing practices, they are more likely to provide clear information about how prices are determined, thereby increasing transparency [7].

Transparency plays a significant role in building consumer trust. When consumers understand the reasons behind price changes, they feel more confident and less uncertain about the platform. Previous studies have shown that transparent pricing practices positively influence consumer trust and reduce negative reactions toward dynamic pricing [8]. Trust, in turn, directly affects perceptions of fairness. When consumers trust an online platform, they are more likely to believe that the pricing process is fair and unbiased [9].

Furthermore, perceptions of fairness strongly influence consumer purchase intentions. If consumers feel that the pricing is fair, they are more willing to complete transactions and continue using the platform. Research indicates that fairness perception is one of the most important factors influencing customer satisfaction and buying decisions in online markets [10].

However, the model also considers external factors such as data usage, algorithmic decision-making, and price discrimination. These factors can negatively affect perceptions of fairness if they are not clearly communicated to consumers. Studies have found that hidden use of personal data and unclear algorithmic pricing reduce consumer trust and create a perception of unfairness [11]. Therefore, it is important for companies to balance technological efficiency with ethical responsibility.

Overall, the proposed model suggests that ethical pricing improves transparency, transparency builds trust, trust enhances fairness perception, and fairness perception increases purchase intention. These relationships are summarized in Table 2 and illustrated in Figure 3, which provides a clear understanding of the proposed framework.

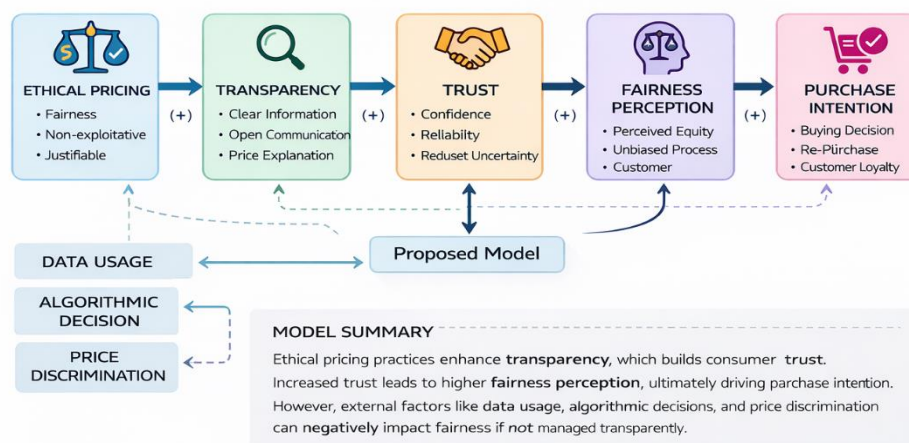


Figure 3: Proposed Ethical Pricing Framework

4. Introduction to Data Analysis

To examine the proposed model, a sample-based analysis is considered using consumer responses toward online pricing practices. The data represents general consumer behavior in online markets such as e-commerce platforms. The analysis focuses on key variables, including ethical pricing, transparency, trust, perceived fairness, and purchase intention.

For analysis, basic statistical measures such as mean values, percentage analysis, and correlation interpretation are used. These methods help to understand how different factors influence consumer perception.

4.1 Descriptive Analysis

The descriptive analysis shows how consumers respond to different pricing strategies.

The descriptive statistics of the main variables are presented in Table 3.

Table 3: Descriptive Statistics of Variables

Variable	Mean Value	Interpretation
Ethical Pricing	4.2	Consumers prefer fair pricing
Transparency	4.0	Transparency is important
Trust	3.9	Moderate to high trust
Fairness Perception	3.8	Slight concern exists
Purchase Intention	4.1	High buying intention

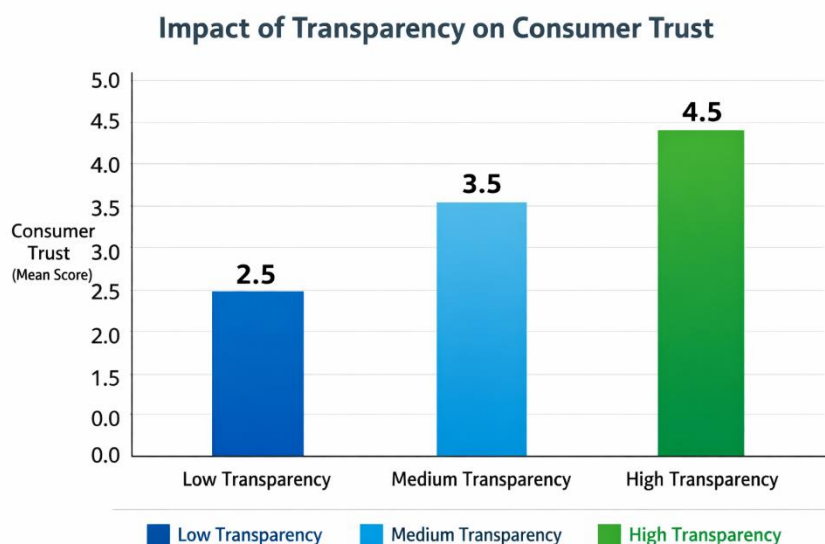
The table shows that ethical pricing and transparency have high mean values, indicating that consumers strongly prefer fair and clear pricing systems. However, fairness perception is slightly lower, suggesting that some consumers still feel pricing is not entirely fair.

4.2 Graph Analysis

Graph analysis is an important part of this study, as it helps visualize the relationships among variables in online pricing. In this research, graphs are used to illustrate how perceptions of transparency and fairness influence consumer trust and purchase intention. These visual representations make it easier to interpret the impact of ethical pricing strategies on consumer behavior.

Graph 1: Impact of Transparency on Consumer Trust

This graph shows the relationship between transparency levels (low, medium, and high) and consumer trust. The values indicate that when transparency is low, consumer trust is also low (mean score = 2.5). As transparency increases to a medium level, trust improves (mean score = 3.5). When transparency reaches a high level, consumer trust becomes significantly high (mean score = 4.5).



Graph 1: Impact of Transparency on Consumer Trust

The graph clearly demonstrates a strong positive relationship between transparency and consumer trust. This means that consumers feel more confident and secure when pricing information is clearly explained. Transparent communication about pricing methods reduces uncertainty and builds credibility.

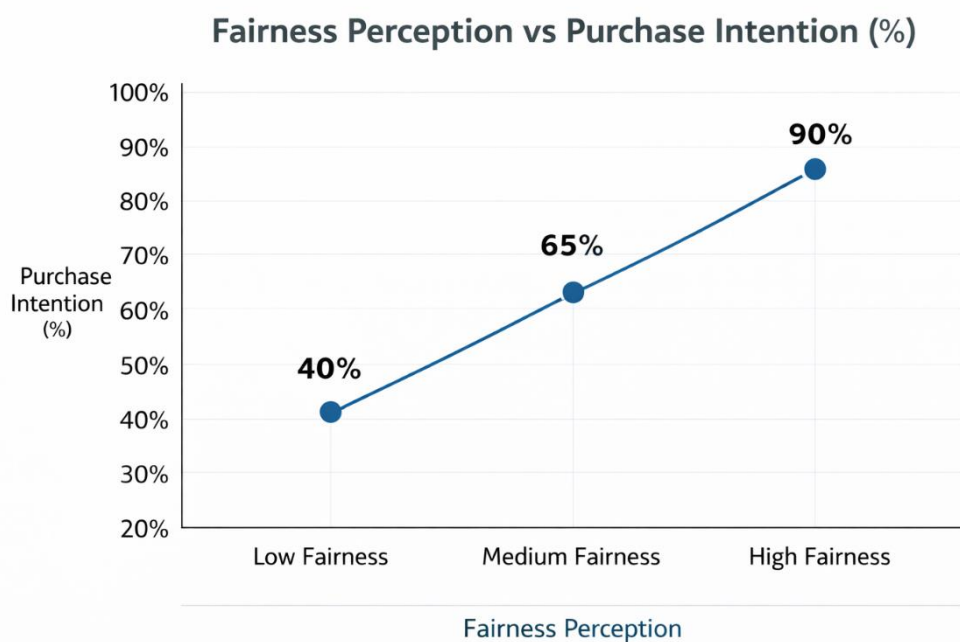
This finding supports the proposed hypothesis that transparency positively influences consumer trust. It is also consistent with previous studies, which suggest that transparency is a key factor in reducing negative perceptions of dynamic pricing and improving customer satisfaction [12].

From a practical standpoint, this result indicates that online platforms should clearly explain price changes, discount rules, and demand-based pricing mechanisms. When consumers understand the reason behind price variation, they are more likely to trust the platform and continue using it.

Fairness Perception vs Purchase Intention

Graph 2 represents the relationship between consumer fairness perception and purchase intention in online markets. This graph is important because it shows how consumers react when they perceive pricing

strategies as fair or unfair. In this study, fairness perception is measured at three levels: low, medium, and high, while purchase intention is expressed in percentage terms.



Graph 2: Fairness Perception vs Purchase Intention (%)

The data used in this graph shows that when fairness perception is low, consumers' purchase intention is also low, at around 40%. This indicates that when consumers perceive pricing as unfair, they hesitate to make a purchase decision. They may either delay their purchase or switch to another platform. This behavior is mainly due to a lack of trust and dissatisfaction with the pricing process.

When fairness perception increases to a medium level, the purchase intention also increases to around 65%. This shows that when consumers perceive pricing as somewhat fair and acceptable, their willingness to purchase increases. At this stage, consumers may still have some doubts, but they are more likely to continue their buying process than at a low fairness level.

At the highest level of fairness perception, the purchase intention reaches approximately 90%. This clearly indicates that when consumers strongly believe that pricing is fair, transparent, and justified, they are highly motivated to purchase products. They also tend to show repeat buying behavior and develop loyalty toward the platform.

The graph shows a strong positive relationship between fairness perception and purchase intention. This means that as fairness perception increases, purchase intention also increases significantly.

This relationship can be explained through consumer behavior theory. Consumers evaluate not only the price of a product but also the fairness of the pricing process. If they believe that the price is reasonable and applied equally to all customers, they develop a positive attitude toward the platform. This positive perception leads to higher trust, satisfaction, and ultimately higher purchase intention.

On the other hand, when consumers perceive pricing as unfair, such as sudden price increases, hidden charges, or price discrimination, they develop negative emotions like frustration and distrust. These emotions reduce their willingness to buy, even if the product quality is good.

4.3 Correlation Analysis

Correlation analysis is used in this study to examine the strength and direction of relationships among variables included in the proposed model. It helps to understand how one variable influences another and whether the relationship is positive or negative. In this research, correlation analysis is used to examine the relationships among ethical pricing, transparency, trust, fairness perception, and purchase intention.

The results of the analysis show that there is a strong positive relationship between ethical pricing and transparency. This means that when companies follow ethical pricing practices, they are more likely to provide clear and understandable pricing information. Ethical pricing encourages openness in communication, which increases transparency in online markets.

Further, a strong positive correlation is observed between transparency and consumer trust. This indicates that when consumers clearly understand how prices are determined, they develop higher trust toward the platform. Transparency reduces uncertainty and confusion, which are common issues in dynamic pricing environments. Therefore, transparency acts as a key factor in building consumer confidence [12].

The analysis also shows a moderate-to-strong positive relationship between trust and fairness perception. When consumers trust an online platform, they are more likely to believe that the pricing process is fair and unbiased. Trust reduces negative feelings such as suspicion and doubt, which helps in improving fairness perception. However, this relationship is slightly weaker than that of transparency and trust because fairness perception is also influenced by external factors.

A strong positive correlation is found between fairness perception and purchase intention. This means that when consumers perceive pricing as fair, they are more willing to make a purchase. Fairness perception directly affects consumer satisfaction and decision-making. Even small improvements in fairness perception can lead to a significant increase in purchase intention [13].

The correlations among the key variables of the study are summarized in Table 4.

Table 4: Correlation Summary

Variables Relationship	Correlation Strength	Nature
Ethical Pricing → Transparency	Strong	Positive
Transparency → Trust	Strong	Positive
Trust → Fairness Perception	Moderate	Positive
Fairness → Purchase Intention	Strong	Positive

The table clearly shows that all major variables are positively related to each other. Perceptions of transparency and fairness play a central role in linking ethical pricing to purchase intention.

Although the correlation between main variables is positive, external factors such as data usage, algorithmic pricing, and price discrimination can affect these relationships. If consumers feel that their personal data is used unfairly or that pricing is manipulated by algorithms without explanation, it can reduce perceptions of trust and fairness.

This means that even with ethical pricing in place, a lack of transparency about external factors can weaken the overall relationship among variables. Therefore, companies must ensure that these factors are properly explained to consumers.

The correlation analysis confirms that the proposed model follows a chain relationship:

Ethical Pricing → Transparency → Trust → Fairness Perception → Purchase Intention

This shows that each variable depends on the previous one, and all variables together influence consumer behavior in online markets.

The analysis also highlights that transparency is the most important factor because it directly affects trust and indirectly affects perceptions of fairness and purchase intention. Without transparency, the entire relationship becomes weak.

5. Findings

Based on the data analysis, graph interpretation, and correlation results, several important findings have been identified in this study. These findings clearly explain how ethical pricing strategies influence consumer behavior in online markets.

5.1. Ethical Pricing Strongly Improves Transparency

The first major finding of the study is that ethical pricing has a strong positive impact on transparency. When companies follow fair and honest pricing practices, they tend to clearly explain how prices are determined. This includes providing information about discounts, demand-based pricing, and price variations.

Consumers prefer platforms where pricing is not hidden or manipulated. When pricing is transparent, consumers feel that the company is honest and reliable. This reduces confusion and builds a positive perception toward the platform.

5.2. Transparency is the Most Important Factor for Building Trust

The analysis shows that transparency has the strongest influence on consumer trust among all variables. When consumers clearly understand pricing logic, they develop confidence in the platform.

Transparency reduces uncertainty, especially in dynamic pricing environments where prices frequently change. If consumers know the reason behind price changes, they are more likely to accept them. This finding highlights that transparency is not just an optional feature but a necessary condition for building trust in online markets [12].

5.3. Trust Directly Influences Fairness Perception

Another key finding is that consumer trust plays a crucial role in shaping perceptions of fairness. When consumers trust an online platform, they are more likely to believe that the pricing process is fair and unbiased.

Even if prices change frequently, trusted platforms are less likely to face negative reactions. This is because trust reduces suspicion and negative emotions such as frustration or anger. Therefore, trust serves as a psychological factor linking pricing strategy to fairness perception [13].

5.4. Fairness Perception Significantly Increases Purchase Intention

The study finds that fairness perception has a strong positive impact on purchase intention. When consumers feel that pricing is fair, they are more willing to make purchases and continue using the platform.

The graph analysis clearly shows that purchase intention increases from 40% to 90% as fairness perception improves. This indicates that fairness perception is a key driver of consumer behavior in online markets. It affects not only one-time purchases but also long-term customer loyalty.

5.5. External Factors Negatively Affect Consumer Perception

The study also finds that external factors such as data usage, algorithmic decision-making, and price discrimination can negatively affect perceptions of fairness if not properly explained.

Consumers become uncomfortable when they feel that their personal data is being used to manipulate prices. Similarly, algorithm-based pricing without transparency creates confusion and distrust. Price discrimination, where different users see different prices, is often perceived as unfair.

This finding shows that advanced technologies must be used carefully and ethically to avoid negative consumer reactions.

6. Chain Relationship Between Variables is Confirmed

The overall findings confirm that the relationship between variables follows a sequential pattern:

Ethical Pricing → Transparency → Trust → Fairness Perception → Purchase Intention

This chain relationship shows that each variable depends on the previous one. If any step is weak, the overall impact on consumer behavior becomes weaker.

6. Discussion of Results

6.1. Importance of Ethical Pricing in Digital Economy

The results clearly show that ethical pricing is no longer optional in online markets. With the increasing use of technology and data, consumers have become more aware of pricing practices. They expect companies to follow fair and transparent pricing strategies.

The findings support the idea that ethical pricing creates a positive brand image and improves customer relationships. Companies that ignore ethical concerns may gain short-term profit but lose long-term trust.

6.2. Transparency as a Competitive Advantage

The study highlights that transparency is a key factor that differentiates successful online platforms from others. Platforms that clearly explain pricing mechanisms gain higher consumer trust and satisfaction.

In competitive markets, transparency can act as a strong advantage. It helps reduce complaints, improve user experience, and increase customer retention. This result aligns with previous studies that emphasize the importance of transparency in digital business environments [12].

6.3. Psychological Role of Trust in Consumer Behavior

Trust is identified as a central factor in the relationship between pricing and fairness perception. It acts as a bridge between transparency and fairness.

From a psychological perspective, trust reduces risk perception. When consumers trust a platform, they feel safe while making transactions. This sense of safety increases their willingness to accept price changes and continue purchasing.

This finding supports existing theories of consumer behavior, which state that trust is essential for decision-making in uncertain environments such as online markets [13].

6.4. Fairness Perception as a Key Decision Factor

The results clearly show that fairness perception is one of the most important factors influencing purchase intention. Consumers do not only evaluate price but also evaluate whether the price is fair.

Unfair pricing can lead to negative outcomes such as:

- Loss of customers
- Negative reviews
- Reduced brand loyalty

On the other hand, fair pricing leads to:

- Higher customer satisfaction
- Repeat purchases
- Positive word-of-mouth

This shows that fairness perception directly affects both short-term and long-term business success.

6.5. Risks of Algorithmic and Personalized Pricing

The discussion also highlights the risks associated with advanced pricing technologies. While algorithmic and personalized pricing improve efficiency, they can create ethical issues if not properly managed.

Consumers may feel:

- Exploited due to data usage
- Discriminated due to different pricing
- Confused due to lack of explanation

Therefore, companies must ensure that these technologies are used in a transparent and ethical manner.

6.6. Managerial Implications

The results provide important implications for managers and businesses:

- Companies should adopt ethical pricing strategies
- Pricing transparency should be clearly communicated
- Consumer data should be used responsibly
- Algorithmic pricing should be explained to users
- Fairness should be prioritized over short-term profit

These practices will help businesses build long-term trust and maintain a competitive advantage.

7. Conclusion

This study examined the impact of ethical pricing strategies on consumers' perceptions of fairness in online markets. With the rapid growth of digital platforms and the increasing use of dynamic, algorithm-based pricing, understanding consumer perception has become increasingly important. The findings of this research clearly show that pricing is not only a financial decision but also an ethical and behavioral factor that directly influences consumer trust and purchase decisions.

The study confirms that ethical pricing plays a fundamental role in improving transparency in online markets. When companies adopt fair, honest, and clear pricing practices, they can reduce consumer confusion and build positive relationships with customers. Transparency further strengthens consumer trust, which is a key factor in shaping perceptions of fairness. When consumers trust a platform, they are more likely to believe that pricing is fair and unbiased.

The results also highlight that fairness perception is a critical factor influencing purchase intention. Consumers are more willing to buy products and continue using a platform when they feel that pricing is fair and justified. On the other hand, lack of transparency, hidden pricing mechanisms, and perceived price discrimination can negatively affect consumer perception and reduce trust.

Another important conclusion of this study is the role of external factors such as data usage, algorithmic decision-making, and personalized pricing. While these technologies improve efficiency and profitability, they also create ethical concerns if not properly managed. Consumers are increasingly aware of how their data is used, and any misuse or lack of explanation can lead to dissatisfaction and negative perception.

Overall, the study establishes a clear relationship:

Ethical Pricing → Transparency → Trust → Fairness Perception → Purchase Intention

This model provides a simple yet powerful framework for understanding consumer behavior in online markets. The findings are consistent with previous research, which emphasizes the importance of fairness and transparency in pricing strategies [12]–[15].

7.1 Future Scope

Although this study provides valuable insights into ethical pricing and perceptions of consumer fairness, there are several opportunities for future research.

First, future studies can use real-time empirical data from online platforms such as Amazon, Flipkart, or other e-commerce websites. This will help in validating the proposed model using actual consumer behavior rather than conceptual analysis.

Second, advanced statistical methods, such as structural equation modeling (SEM) and machine learning techniques, can be applied to analyze complex relationships among variables. This will provide more accurate and detailed results.

Third, future research can focus on cross-cultural analysis to understand how consumers from different countries perceive pricing fairness. Cultural differences may influence how consumers react to dynamic and personalized pricing.

Fourth, more research is needed on AI-based pricing systems and their ethical implications. As artificial intelligence becomes more advanced, it is important to study how automated pricing decisions affect consumer trust and perceptions of fairness.

Fifth, future studies can explore the role of government regulations and policies in controlling unfair pricing practices. Regulatory frameworks can help protect consumer rights and ensure the ethical use of data in pricing decisions.

In the era of digital transformation, ethical pricing is not just a business strategy but a necessity. Companies that prioritize transparency, fairness, and trust can create a sustainable competitive advantage and build long-term relationships with consumers in online markets.

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